

CASE STUDY – Bank Merger Stakeholder Programme

Client: Aldgate Bank (fictional) Engagement: February to July 2025

SITUATION

A merger of two retail banks with overlapping branch networks and two incompatible management cultures. The announced synergy case depended on branch closures nobody had yet told the regional directors about.

WHAT WE DID

Stakeholder mapping across 41 named individuals using the influence-versus-alignment method. Identified three regional directors with high informal influence and negative alignment who did not appear in the sponsor's own list. Built a sequenced briefing programme that reached them before the closure announcement rather than after.

RESULT

The closure announcement drew no regional-director public dissent. Two of the three later became programme advocates.

LESSON

Informal power does not appear on an org chart. It appears in who other people mention unprompted in interviews.